Bike commuting in the city

Riding to work can be faster than driving over short distances and costs almost nothing. Start by choosing a route with bike lanes or quiet side streets, even if it is a little longer.

Set up the bike for daily use. You need a white front light and a red rear light, a good U-lock, and fenders for wet roads. A rack with panniers keeps weight off your back. Check the tyre pressure every week.

In traffic, ride predictably in a straight line, signal your turns, and stay out of the door zone beside parked cars. Make eye contact with drivers at junctions and never assume they have seen you.

Dress in layers so you can adjust as you warm up. If your workplace has no shower, pack a change of clothes and wipe down before you start the day.